

Snyk

Developer Security · Boston, MA / London · Private (last primary ~\$7.4B, 2021; ~\$325M ARR; IPO delayed/uncertain)

Developer-security leader Snyk (~\$325M ARR) is now led by a CEO who is also its CFO, with the CMO seat still vacant and no motorsport footprint - a finance-first leadership reset that calls for an ROI-led grid idea before a DevSecOps rival moves.

73

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Aston Martin

ACTION HORIZON

6-8 WKS

THE CASE

Snyk is a well-funded developer-security leader - ~\$325M ARR, 4,800+ customers, \$435M in the bank and a clear path to break-even - on a (delayed) IPO track. The defining dynamic now is a finance-first leadership reset: after Peter McKay's departure, Ken MacAskill leads as CEO while also holding the CFO role, and the CMO seat has been vacant since Jonaki Egenolf left in November 2025. With brand decisions sitting with a CEO who is also the CFO and no marketing chief, a sponsorship must be pitched on hard ROI - measurable pipeline and enterprise credibility - and the open CMO seat is the slot whose thesis we can shape now. The strategic prize: developer/application security is uncontested on the F1 grid (the same whitespace JFrog and Sonatype eye), so a first mover owns the lane.

WHY NOW

The top of the house has just reset - a new CEO/CFO and a still-open CMO seat - so the framing set now shapes both the incoming marketing hire and how a finance-first chief evaluates the deal. Layer on the open DevSecOps category (which locks the moment a rival signs) and a pre-IPO brand rationale, and the case for planting an ROI-led idea now is strong.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$325M

ARR (4,800+ customers)

\$435M

Cash in the bank; clear path to break-even

~\$7.4B

Last primary valuation (down from \$8.5B in 2021); secondary marks lower

Ken MacAskill

CEO & CFO (combined role, after Peter McKay's departure)

CMO seat vacant

No CMO on the leadership page (Egenolf left Nov 2025)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Aston Martin	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	TAKEN	data platform / storage, identity & access security
McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A ~\$325M-ARR developer-security leader now run by a CEO who is also its CFO, with the CMO seat still open - so brand decisions sit with a finance-first chief and the pitch must be ROI-led. Developer security is uncontested on the F1 grid; Aston Martin is the CISO-credible home.

NEVER ENTEREDCATEGORY WHITESPACEFUNDING EVENTNEW LEADERSHIPDISCOVERY: SELF

WHY ASTON MARTIN

Aston Martin's CISO-grade gravitas and premium, technically-credible identity place Snyk's 'secure by design' story directly in front of the enterprise security buyers it sells to. If Aston Martin's inventory is constrained, Williams (data/engineering revival) is a credible alternative with the right audience profile.

VALUE TO ASTON MARTIN — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - real substance on three fronts. (1) TECHNICAL: an F1 team is a software company in disguise - hundreds of engineers shipping race-strategy code, aero/vehicle-dynamics simulation, telemetry pipelines and trackside tooling on aggressive weekly cycles, all of it built on open-source dependencies and containers. That is precisely Snyk's surface: scanning code, dependencies, containers and infrastructure-as-code inside the developers' own workflow, so security never slows the build cadence. Critically, this COMPLEMENTS Aston Martin's existing SentinelOne partnership (endpoint/runtime protection) rather than overlapping it - Snyk secures the code before it ships, SentinelOne defends the machines it runs on, giving the team a genuinely complete security story. F1 teams are high-value IP-theft targets (designs, strategy models), so protecting the development pipeline is a real operational need, and the team becomes Snyk's flagship reference deployment. (2) COMMERCIAL: Aston Martin's paddock audience skews to exactly the CISO/CTO/VP-Engineering buyers Snyk sells to - race-weekend hospitality becomes a working enterprise pipeline channel, and Snyk's 4,800+ customers give the team a credible B2B co-marketing reach. (3) CONTENT & TALENT: a 'securing the code that races' content platform (developer-audience storytelling is Snyk's native motion) plus an engineering-recruiting halo for both sides. The team gains a complete, defensible security narrative and real pipeline tooling; Snyk gains the stage, the reference and the buyers in the room.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Developer Security Partner tier on Aston Martin, minimum three years, ~\$3-4M/yr (calibrated to ~\$325M ARR), with developer-security category exclusivity and a working integration into the team's development pipeline.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Ken MacAskill
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER & CFO, SNYK - VERIFIED VIA
SNYK.IO/ABOUT/LEADERSHIP

Ken MacAskill leads Snyk as CEO while also holding the CFO role, having stepped up after Peter McKay's departure. The combined CEO/CFO seat means brand and sponsorship decisions sit with a finance-first chief - so the pitch must be ROI-led (measurable pipeline and credibility), not brand vanity. There is no CMO (the seat has been vacant since Jonaki Egenolf left in Nov 2025), so framing the thesis for the eventual marketing hire is part of the play. Co-decision-makers: CRO Tom Nielsen (commercial) and Chief Innovation Officer & CTO Manoj Nair (a working technical integration).

OPENING ANGLE

"Ken, you run Snyk as CEO and CFO, so you'll judge this on return, not noise: developer security is the one open lane on the F1 grid, and owning it pre-IPO is measurable enterprise credibility with the CISO buyers you sell to. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 14 / 20 Leadership has reset at the top: Ken MacAskill (ex-Interim CFO) now leads as CEO & CFO after Peter McKay's departure, with the CMO seat still vacant - brand decisions sit with a finance-first chief, so framing must be ROI-led; the reset is the moment to plant the thesis.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 ~\$325M ARR, 4,800+ customers and \$435M in the bank with a path to break-even; valuation is ambiguous (last primary ~\$7.4B in 2021; secondary marks lower).	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 Developer and application security sits in uncontested grid whitespace (the same JFrog/Sonatype eye).	URGENCY 12 / 20 If a DevSecOps rival signs first the category locks - but the IPO is delayed and leadership is mid-reset, so the clock is softer than it looks.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: an F1 team's growing in-house software estate is a genuine developer-security surface and reference deployment.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

FINANCE-FIRST GATEKEEPER, NO CMO Brand spend sits with a CEO who is also the CFO, and there is no marketing chief to champion it - a high bar for discretionary sponsorship. **Counter:** Pitch strictly on ROI (measurable B2B pipeline + a working dev-pipeline deployment as a reference), and frame it as a ready-made win to hand the eventual CMO.

IPO DELAYED / SPEND DISCIPLINE The listing is not imminent and the path-to-break-even posture favours visible efficiency. **Counter:** Lock category exclusivity now at a pre-IPO price; the open DevSecOps lane is the asset, and it disappears the moment a rival signs.

SOURCES

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